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Assignment: Publishing & Sharing Reports in Power BI

Easy Level

Q1. Why is publishing and sharing reports more important than just building them in Desktop?

- **Accessibility:** A report on your laptop helps only you. Publishing it to the cloud means stakeholders can access it from anywhere, on any device.
- **Single Source of Truth:** Sharing ensures everyone in the team is looking at the same updated numbers, rather than different versions of a file.
- **Automated Data:** Only published reports can use "Scheduled Refresh," so your team always sees live data without you manually hitting refresh every morning.

Q2. What is Power BI Service, and how does it differ from Power BI Desktop?

- **Power BI Desktop:** This is your "workshop" where you connect to data, clean it up, and build the actual visuals.
- **Power BI Service:** This is your "broadcast station." It’s a cloud-based platform used to host, share, and collaborate on those reports.
- **The Flow:** You build in Desktop, then publish to Service for others to see.

Q3. What does "Publishing" mean, and what are two main outcomes?

- Publishing is the act of uploading your finished `.pbix` file from your computer to a workspace in the Power BI cloud.
- **Outcome 1:** The **Report** (the visuals) becomes live and shareable via a web link.
- **Outcome 2:** A **Dataset** (Semantic Model) is created in the Service, which can be reused for other reports or scheduled for refreshes.

Medium Level

Q4. What are the steps to publish a report from Desktop to Service?

1. **Save the File:** Make sure all your latest changes are saved locally.
2. **Sign In:** Log into your Power BI Pro/Premium account within the Desktop app.
3. **Click Publish:** Hit the 'Publish' button on the Home ribbon.
4. **Pick a Workspace:** Choose the destination (like "Sales Team" or "My Workspace").

5. **View Online:** Once it says "Success," you get a link to open and view your report in the browser.

Q5. Difference between a Report and a Dashboard?

- **Pages:** A Report can have many pages of detailed visuals, but a Dashboard is just a one-page "at-a-glance" summary.
- **Data Sources:** A Report is usually based on one dataset, while a Dashboard can "pin" visuals from many different reports and datasets.
- **Deep Dive:** You use Reports to filter and find "why" something happened; you use Dashboards to quickly see "what" is happening right now.

Q6. Explain the three sharing methods and their use cases.

- **Direct Sharing:** Sending a single report to one person. (Use case: Sending a specific performance review to a manager) .
- **Workspace Access:** Giving a team access to an entire folder of work. (Use case: A group of analysts collaborating on a project together) .
- **Power BI Apps:** Packaging a group of reports into one clean "app." (Use case: Distributing finalized monthly analytics to the whole company) .

Q7. What are the four Workspace Roles?

1. **Admin:** The owner who can delete the workspace and manage who gets in.
2. **Member:** Can add/edit reports and add other people to lower roles.
3. **Contributor:** Can build and edit reports but cannot share them with others.
4. **Viewer:** Can only see and interact with the reports—no editing allowed.

Hard Level

Q8. Why are Apps better for large companies than direct sharing?

- **Staging:** You can work on a report in the workspace without users seeing your "mess." They only see changes when you choose to "Update App".
- **Security:** It keeps the workspace (the kitchen) separate from the App (the dining room), so users don't accidentally break your data models.

Q9. What is Row-Level Security (RLS)?

- RLS is like a "filter" that changes based on who is logged in.
- **How it works:** You write a rule (DAX) saying "Show data where Region = User's Region." This way, the North manager sees North data, and the South manager sees South data, even though they use the same report.

Q10. What are the risks of sharing without using best practices like RLS or Apps?

1. **Data Privacy Breach:** Without RLS, everyone might see sensitive info (like salaries or private client details) they aren't authorized to see.
2. **Accidental Deletion:** Without proper roles (e.g., everyone is an Admin), a user might accidentally delete a vital report.
3. **Confusion:** Without Apps, users might see "draft" data that isn't ready yet, leading to wrong business decisions.